

IRON STRENGTH

The Bailadila Hills of the Dantewada district in the Bastar area of modern-day Chhattisgarh remained isolated until 1956 when an agreement with the Japanese for the export of 4 million tonnes of iron ore led to a flurry of exploration and construction. Over the course of four years, the railways laid a complex line that crossed the Eastern Ghats. Its sole purpose was to transport iron ore.